Plugin Shelf for REAPER Override

User Manual

REAPER script — Plugin Shelf instead of the native “Add FX” window

Emelowsky

Document version 1.3 (Override 2.4)

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1. Introduction

Plugin Shelf for REAPER Override is a small helper script included with Plugin Shelf. When it is on, it runs in the background and takes care of one thing: every time REAPER opens its native “Add FX” window — for example after clicking the FX button on a track (TCP), in the mixer (MCP) or on an empty plugin slot — the script closes it right away and opens Plugin Shelf instead.

That way you do not have to change your habits: you click the same buttons as always and land straight in your own categories and icons in Plugin Shelf. It is fully reversible — turn the script off and REAPER's native window is back.

The script is a single file: `Emelowsky - Plugin Shelf for REAPER Override.lua`. It has no window and no settings of its own.

> **Tip:** If Plugin Shelf is already open, Override closes it and opens it again — for the track you have just clicked. There is no need to close it by hand.

2. Requirements and installation

2.1 What you need

- REAPER — version 7.03 or newer recommended (older versions work too, but show a “Terminate instances” window when turning the script off, see chapter 3).
- Plugin Shelf, installed according to its manual and added to the Action List.
- The js_ReaScriptAPI extension, installed via ReaPack (Extensions → ReaPack → Browse packages…, search for “js_ReaScriptAPI”). Without it the script shows a message and does not start.
- REAPER in English (no translated interface / LangPack) — the script recognizes the native window by its “Add FX” title.

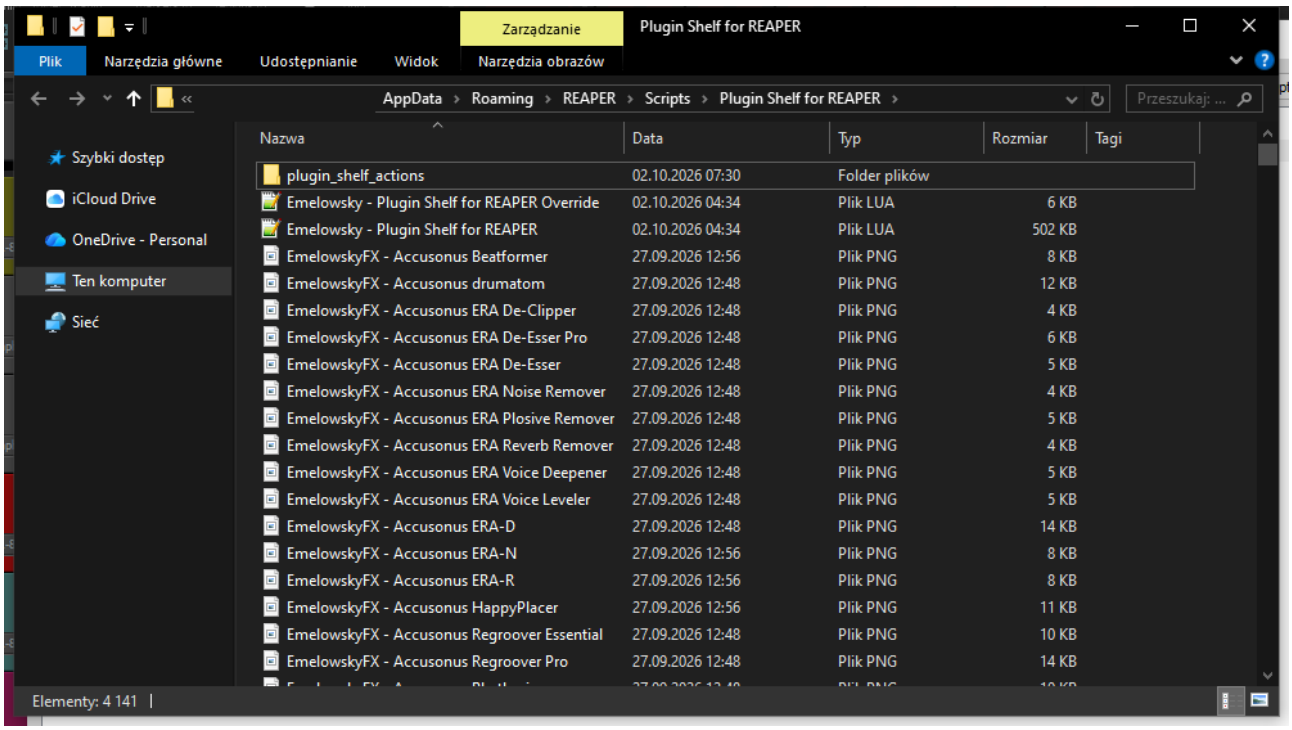
2.2 Installing the file

1. Copy `Emelowsky - Plugin Shelf for REAPER Override.lua` into THE SAME folder where Plugin Shelf lives, e.g. `Scripts/Plugin Shelf for REAPER/`.
2. In REAPER: Actions → Show action list… → New action… → Load ReaScript…, and point it to the copied file.
3. Optionally add the action as a toolbar button — the button lights up while Override is on.

> **Important:** The file must sit in the same folder as Plugin Shelf. The script reads the message language from there, and if Plugin Shelf is not in the Action List yet, it adds it there by itself (the same as a manual “Load ReaScript…”).

With ReaPack: Override installs together with the “Emelowsky - Plugin Shelf for REAPER” package into Scripts/Emelowsky/Plugin Shelf for REAPER/ (a different folder than the manual install) and appears in the Action List by itself — no copying and no adding by hand.

There is nothing to configure: Override finds the Plugin Shelf action on its own on every computer. It first looks for it in the Action List (Plugin Shelf from the same folder takes priority), and if it is not there, it registers Plugin Shelf from its own folder.

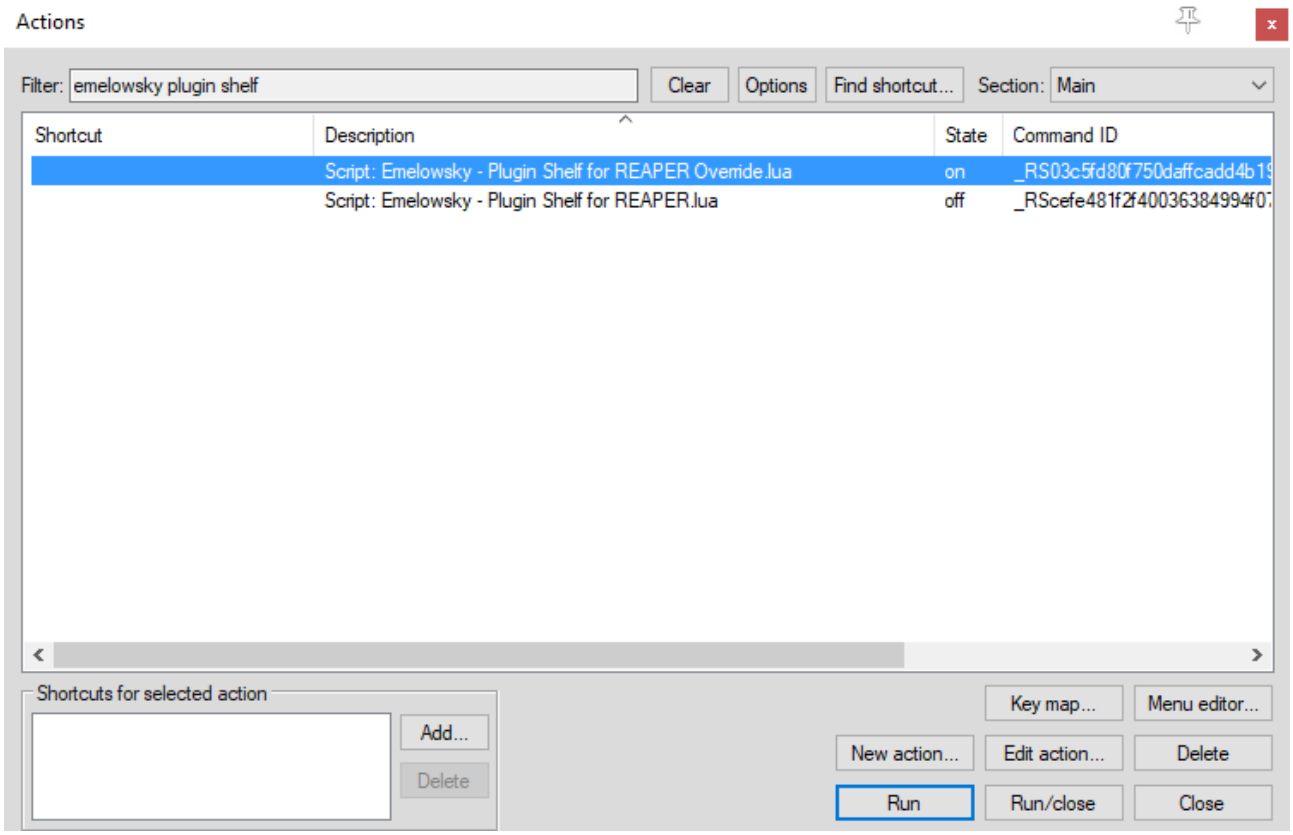


Note: Have an older version of the helper named Emelowsky - FX_Browser_Override.lua? Remove its entry from the Action List (Remove), delete the old file and load the new one following the steps above.

3. Turning it on and off

1. Run the “Emelowsky - Plugin Shelf for REAPER Override” action from the Action List (or click its toolbar button). The script does not open any window — from now on it runs in the background and its toolbar button lights up.
2. Click the FX button on any track — Plugin Shelf opens instead of the “Add FX” window.
3. To turn Override off, run the same action again. The toolbar button goes dark and REAPER opens its native window again.

In REAPER older than 7.03, running it again shows a window asking what to do with the running script. Tick “Remember my answer for this script” and click “Terminate instances” — from then on the script turns off without asking.



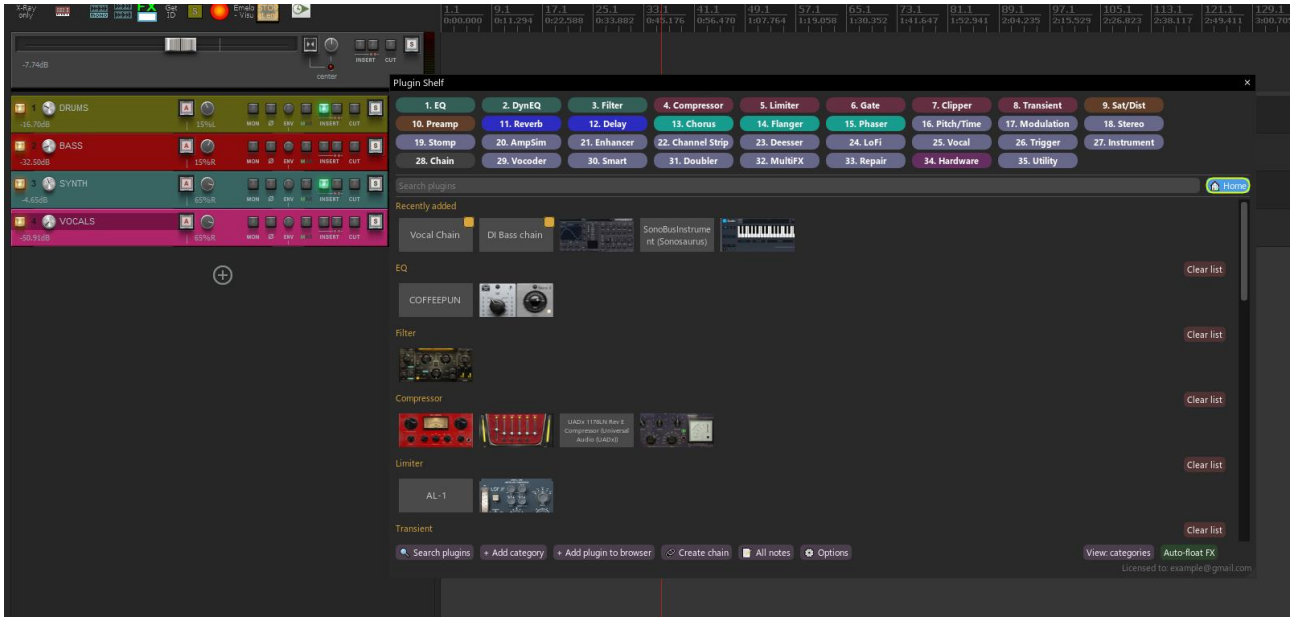
3.1 Turning it on automatically when REAPER starts

Override runs until you close REAPER. If you want it to start by itself, set it as a startup action with the SWS extension: Extensions → Startup actions → Set global startup action…, then pick the “Emelowsky - Plugin Shelf for REAPER Override” action.

4. How it works in practice

- The FX button on a track (TCP) or in the mixer (MCP), an empty plugin slot, and any other place from which REAPER opens the “Add FX” window — Plugin Shelf opens instead.
- You add plugins exactly as always in Plugin Shelf — by clicking a tile, with a preset, or as a chain.
- The FX window (the list of plugins on a track) works as usual — Override intercepts only the window for choosing a new plugin.
- The script's messages use the same language you set in Plugin Shelf (PL / EN / ES / DE / FR).
- When Plugin Shelf is already open, the FX button just brings its window to the front (new in Override 2.4 with Plugin Shelf 3.7.94) — Plugin Shelf is not closed and started again, so it is there right away, also above an “FX: Track” window that is set to stay on top.

> **Tip:** Need REAPER's native window for a moment (e.g. to check a plugin you have not added to Plugin Shelf yet)? Turn Override off with one click of its toolbar button, then turn it back on.



5. Troubleshooting

Message / situation	What to do
“This script requires the js_ReaScriptAPI extension…”	Install js_ReaScriptAPI: Extensions → ReaPack → Browse packages…, search for “js_ReaScriptAPI”, install it and restart REAPER.
“Plugin Shelf was not found…”	Move Emelowsky - Plugin Shelf for REAPER Override.lua into the folder where Plugin Shelf lives, load Plugin Shelf into the Action List (New action… → Load ReaScript…) and run Override again.
The native “Add FX” window still opens while Override is on	Check that the Override toolbar button is lit (the script is running). If you use a translated REAPER interface, the window has a different title and the script does not recognize it — switch REAPER to English.
A different (older) version of Plugin Shelf opens	Remove the entries of old Plugin Shelf versions from the Action List, keep only the current one and run Override again.
A “Terminate instances” window appears when turning it off	This is REAPER older than 7.03. Tick “Remember my answer for this script” and click “Terminate instances”.
After updating there are two Override entries in the Action List	Remove the old entry (Emelowsky - FX_Browser_Override.lua) from the Action List and delete the old file from the folder.

6. Contact and support

For questions or problems, write to emelowsky.plugins@gmail.com. When reporting a problem, include your REAPER version, operating system and the exact text of the message — it makes helping you much faster.